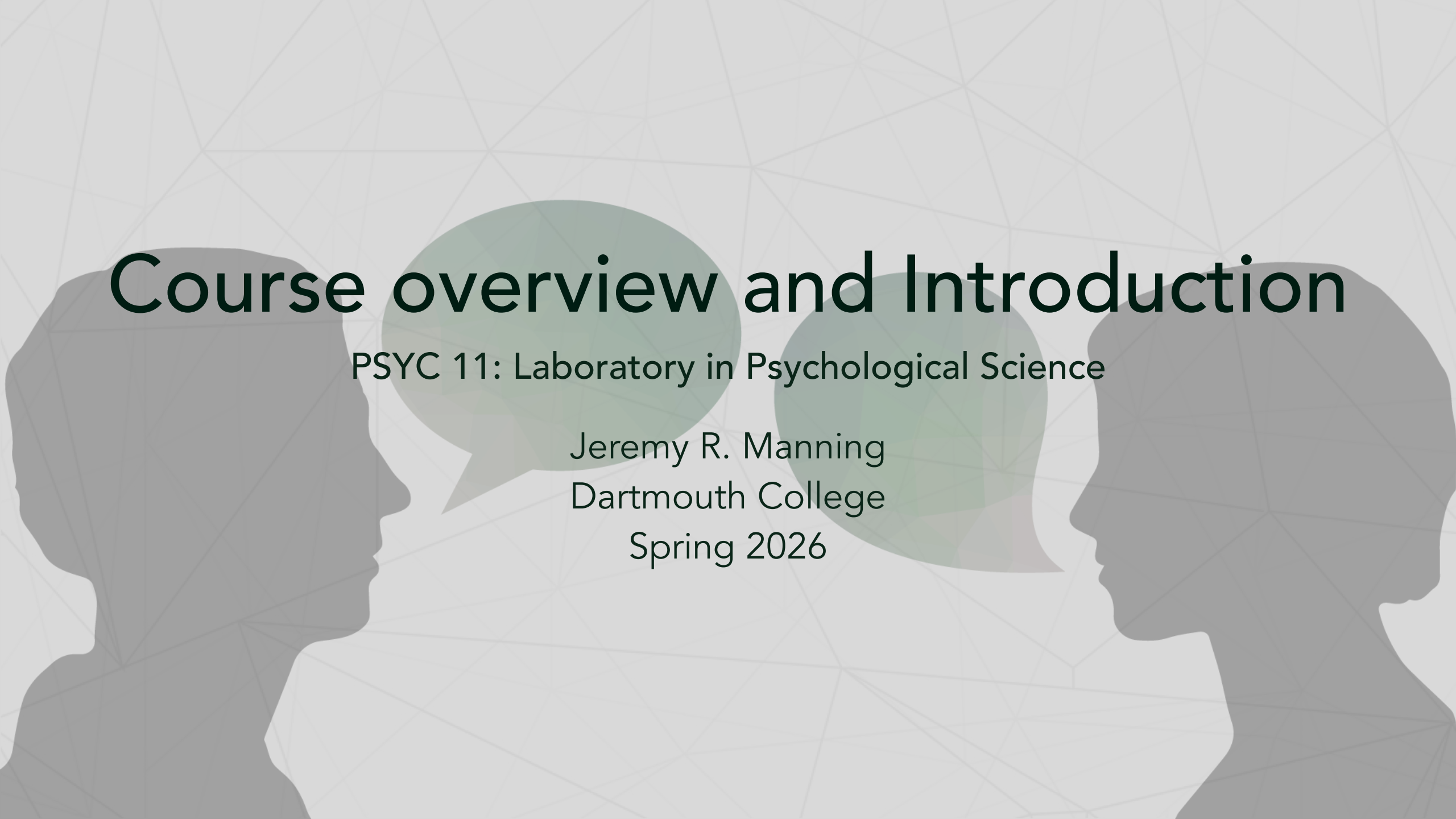




Course overview and Introduction

PSYC 11: Laboratory in Psychological Science

Jeremy R. Manning
Dartmouth College
Spring 2026

What is this course about?

Course Goals

- Learn how to carry out psychological research
- Doing research vs. writing a (complete) scientific article

Sections of a Scientific Article

- **Introduction:** motivate your research question
- **Methods:** describe how you studied the question
- **Results:** describe what you found
- **Discussion:** situate your findings in the broader literature

Why should you care about writing?

Writing Matters

- Formulate your question and approach
- Share what you did and found
- Learn to read and critically evaluate other work

Organization

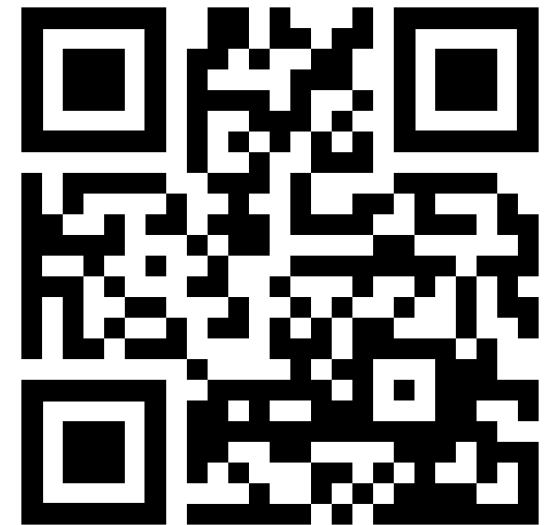
Course Structure

- **First 5(ish) weeks:** in-class labs, each focused on teaching you about one section of scientific articles
- **Last 5(ish) weeks:** carry out your own research study
- **Goal:** leave this course with a deep understanding of how psychological research is "done"

Logistics

Course Resources

- All materials, including assignments, readings, etc, are provided on the course [GitHub page](#)
- We'll use [Slack](#) to communicate, share materials and data, etc.
- You should bring your laptop to every class



Logistics

Office Hours

- I'll hold **office hours** by appointment on Mondays and Thursdays. Schedule through: context-lab.youcanbook.me (or email me).

Communication

- If you post questions on Slack, I'll answer them (usually within 1-2 business days).
- If you have any comments, questions, concerns, etc., **please let me know** (via Slack DMs or email: jeremy@dartmouth.edu).

Teaching assistants

TAs

- Sarah Kerns
- Yeongji Lee
- Zizhuang Miao



Contextual Dynamics Lab

What We Do

- Build brain models to understand how our brain structures interact during learning and memory
- Computational models, data science tools
- More info: www.context-lab.com



Birthday lab!

Scientific Thinking

- Gentle introduction to asking questions in a scientific way (aside: how is this different from a "regular" question?)
- Does anyone **know** they have a birthday twin in the room?
- How many people would you **expect** to have matching birthdays?
- What makes a "good" hypothesis vs. a "bad" hypothesis?

Birthday lab!

Today's Task

- Today's job: collect some data!

